

Yuanyuan Hu

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RESEARCH PROFILE

I study how genetic and environmental influences shape individual differences in brain structure and networks, with a focus on anxiety, depression, self-regulation, and transdiagnostic mental-health risk. My work combines twin designs, structural and functional neuroimaging, behavioral genetics, normative modeling, and connectome-based analyses.

EDUCATION

Doctor of Philosophy, Cognitive Neuroscience

03/2025 – Present

Institute of Psychology, Chinese Academy of Sciences, Beijing. Using twin data to investigate the brain mechanisms through which genetic and environmental factors influence mental health. Supervisor: Prof. Yuan Zhou.

Master of Philosophy, Applied Psychology

09/2022 – 03/2025

Institute of Psychology, Chinese Academy of Sciences, Beijing. Using computational modelling and experimental psychology to study behavioural decision-making. Supervisor: Prof. Yuan Zhou.

Bachelor of Philosophy, Applied Psychology

09/2018 – 06/2022

Faculty of Psychology, Southwest University, Chongqing. Trained in research on procrastination. Supervisor: Prof. Tingyong Feng.

RESEARCH FOCUS AND METHODS

Focus: Affective psychopathology: anxiety and depression; Behavioral genetics and twin neuroimaging; Individual differences in self-regulation.

Methods: Twin-based ACE and multivariate genetic modeling. Structural MRI, resting-state fMRI, connectome, and network analysis. Normative modeling, representational similarity analysis, spatial-null inference, and reproducible workflows in Python, MATLAB, and R.

SELECTED AWARDS AND HONOURS

2026 Director's Scholarship, Institute of Psychology, Chinese Academy of Sciences (Top 5 institute-wide)

2026 Best Presentation Award (3/500) and Best Academic Communication Award (3/988), First Capital Universities Undergraduate Academic Conference

2025 Outstanding Student (Top 15%) and Outstanding Student Model (Top 1%), University of Chinese Academy of Sciences

2022–2025 Academic Excellence Scholarship, University of Chinese Academy of Sciences

2022 Undergraduate Scholarship, University of Chinese Academy of Sciences

Languages: English - Advanced (IELTS 7.0).

SELECTED PUBLICATIONS

- Yuanyuan Hu**, Jie Xiang, Yuening Jin, et al. (2026). [Shared neurogenetic substrates of nonplanning impulsivity and procrastination](#). *Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences*, 123(28), e2605127123. Independent first author | SCI · Q1 · 5-year IF 10.6
- Yuanyuan Hu**#, Yancheng Tang#, Wei Li#, et al. (2026). [Shared neurogenetic architecture links adolescent neurodevelopmental deviations to adult psychopathological procrastination](#). *Molecular Psychiatry*, 31(5), 2739–2753. Co-first author, 3 first authors | SCI · Q1 · 5-year IF 12.2
- Zhiyi Chen#, Yancheng Tang#, Xuerong Liu, Wei Li#, **Yuanyuan Hu**#, et al. (2024). [Edge-centric connectome-genetic markers of bridging factor to comorbidity between depression and anxiety](#). *Nature Communications*, 15, 10560. Co-first author, 5 first authors | SCI · Q1 · 5-year IF 18.9
- Yuanyuan Hu**#, Yuening Jin#, Bowen Hu, et al. (2024). [Computational modeling interpretation underlying elevated risk-taking propensity in the dynamic risky investment process of non-labor income](#). *Psychology Research and Behavior Management*, 17, 2491–2504. Co-first author, 2 first authors | SSCI · Q1 · 5-year IF 4.5
- Yuanyuan Hu**#, Jingjie Zhao#, Yuening Jin, et al. (2024). [The altered resting-state functional connectivity of thalamic subregions in patients with globus pharyngeus](#). *Brain Imaging and Behavior*, 19(1), 23–31. Co-first author, 2 first authors | SCI · Q2 · 5-year IF 3.1

Equal contribution. Full author lists and collaborative publications: [Extended CV](#) | [ORCID](#)